Purpose

Helping students understand what they are learning and why

Use a clear purpose to help students understand what the lesson is building towards and why the learning matters. Connect activities to the knowledge, performance or later use.

How to do it well

1 Define the destination. State the knowledge or performance students will develop, using language they can understand.

2 Select a concrete frame. Use an endpoint question, model or meaningful application to show what the learning enables.

3 Connect the first step. Explain how today's component contributes to the larger idea.

4 Keep the purpose visible in practice. Refer to it when choosing examples, checking a decision or explaining an improvement.

5 Return to the destination. Ask students to use the learning in the original question or a related task so the purpose has a concrete outcome.

What this sounds like

"We are learning how evidence supports a historical judgement. This paragraph gives us a way to compare explanations rather than list events."

Classroom example. A Product Design lesson frames material properties through a concrete selection problem. The teacher explains how each taught property helps justify the choice. Practice returns to that same decision with a different product. The purpose connects activity to disciplinary reasoning rather than an artificial claim that every detail has an immediate everyday use.

Top tips that make the technique work

Name the learning rather than the activity. "Explain the cause" is clearer than "Complete the worksheet."

Keep purpose concrete. A question, performance or problem can make the destination visible.

Show a genuine connection. Use the curriculum or subject application rather than an invented claim that every idea is needed in daily life.

Revisit at the decision point. Explain how the current step contributes to the endpoint.

Preserve curiosity without delaying instruction. A hook is useful when it directs attention towards the learning, not when it becomes a separate entertainment.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Connect the task to a clear learning destination.	An activity label presented as the purpose.
Use a meaningful subject rationale.	A lengthy motivational introduction unrelated to the content.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

Barton — Purpose